



1859 Aussie rules

The rules for Australia's version of football were established by members of the Melbourne Cricket Club. It's thought the sport was invented to keep cricketers fit during their off-season.

Born this day

1971 Queen Máxima, Queen Consort of the Netherlands. She works to help immigrants, especially women, settle into Dutch society.

1900 Wonderful Wizard of Oz

US author Lyman Frank Baum gave the first printed copy of his novel to his sister Mary. The story, about a young girl's adventures in the magical land of Oz with her friends the lion, the tin man, and the scarecrow, was later made into a much-loved film.



May

17



1970 Papyrus boat voyage

Norwegian scientist Thor Heyerdahl set sail from Morocco in an attempt to cross the Atlantic Ocean. Heyerdahl and his crew travelled in a papyrus boat, crafted by the Aymara people of Bolivia. They arrived in Barbados 57 days later.

Also on this day

1861 Scottish scientist James Clerk Maxwell showed the first colour photograph – a picture of a tartan ribbon – at King's College London, UK.

1902 The Antikythera Mechanism – the world's first-known mechanical computer – was identified among the artefacts recovered from an ancient Greek shipwreck.

1954 The US Supreme Court ruled that having separate schools for white and Black students was illegal.